

ETERNAL

Creative & Client Team — Monthly All-Hands Notes
January – March 2026 | Internal & Confidential

Eternal, Dubai

Meeting 1: January All-Hands

Date: Wednesday, 14 January 2026 | **Time:** 9:30–11:00 AM (Dubai, GST)

Location: Studio A, Eternal HQ + Microsoft Teams

Attendees:

- Sophia Al-Rashed — CEO (Chair)
- Marcus Webb — Creative Director
- Layla Haddad — Head of Client Services
- Tariq Osman — Senior Brand Strategist
- Priya Nair — Senior Designer
- Jonas Berger — Copywriter
- Fatima Al-Qassem — Account Manager
- Ravi Subramaniam — Operations Manager (remote)

Agenda Item 1 — 2026 Agency Direction

Sophia opened by sharing the board-approved agency strategy for 2026. The focus is a deliberate narrowing of Eternal's positioning: moving away from generalist brand work towards a specialisation in luxury, hospitality, and premium lifestyle. This means selective pitching — no more chasing volume — and a target roster of 12–15 retained clients by year end, down from the current 23. The room had questions about revenue impact; Sophia confirmed the CFO has modelled a 15% revenue reduction in H1 followed by a recovery by Q3 if the repositioning is executed well. Layla expressed concern about communicating changes to existing clients outside the new focus. Sophia agreed to draft a client communication framework by 31 January.

Agenda Item 2 — Q1 Client Project Status

Layla walked through the active project board. The Lumière Hotel Group rebrand is the flagship project for Q1; brand strategy has been signed off and visual identity development begins in week 3. The Al Baraka retail identity project is on hold — client has paused pending an internal restructure and has asked for a 60-day hold. Fatima confirmed the hold is documented and billing is paused accordingly. Two smaller logo projects (Nexus Co-Working, Saffron Wellness) are on track and will wrap by end of January.

Agenda Item 3 — Team Capacity and Freelance Bench

Marcus flagged that the design team will be under pressure in February when the Lumière visual identity goes into full production. Priya confirmed the current team of 3 designers is insufficient for the scope. Marcus proposed engaging two senior freelance designers for a 6-week period. Ravi confirmed budget is available within the project allocation. Priya to source candidates from the approved freelance roster.

Decisions Made

- Agency repositioning to luxury/hospitality confirmed — effective from 1 February pitching.
- Al Baraka project placed on formal hold; billing paused — owner: Fatima.

- Two freelance designers approved for Lumière project — to be onboarded by 1 February.

Action Items

Action	Owner	Deadline
Draft client communication framework for repositioning	Sophia Al-Rashed	31 Jan 2026
Source and brief two freelance designers for Lumière	Priya Nair	23 Jan 2026
Issue formal hold documentation to Al Baraka client	Fatima Al-Qassem	16 Jan 2026
Complete Nexus and Saffron projects and issue final files	Marcus Webb	30 Jan 2026

Meeting 2: February All-Hands

Date: Wednesday, 11 February 2026 | Time: 9:30–10:45 AM

Location: Studio A + Microsoft Teams

Attendees:

- Sophia Al-Rashed — CEO (Chair)
- Marcus Webb — Creative Director
- Layla Haddad — Head of Client Services
- Tariq Osman — Senior Brand Strategist
- Priya Nair — Senior Designer
- Fatima Al-Qassem — Account Manager
- Yuki Tanaka — Freelance Senior Designer (guest)

Agenda Item 1 — Lumière Hotel Group: Mid-Project Review

Marcus presented the Lumière visual identity in progress: logomark, typographic system, and a first pass at the colour palette. The client review scheduled for 14 February will present two directions. Yuki (freelance) has been leading the secondary direction and joined to present it. Feedback from the room was positive on Direction A (restrained, European luxury feel) and more mixed on Direction B (warmer, more regional). The team agreed Direction A is stronger but should incorporate one element from B — the terracotta accent — as a nod to regional context. Client to receive both for their decision.

Agenda Item 2 — New Business: Pitch for Dune Collective

Sophia introduced an inbound pitch opportunity from Dune Collective, a premium outdoor lifestyle brand based in Riyadh. The brief is a full brand identity and campaign strategy for a new product line launching in September. The pitch is due 5 March. Tariq will lead the strategy component; Marcus will lead creative. Layla will manage the pitch logistics. This is the first live test of the repositioned agency focus and the team is motivated. Budget: internal pitch cost approved at AED 18,000.

Agenda Item 3 — Operations: Workday Go-Live Update

Ravi (remote) provided an update on the Workday HRIS implementation. Go-live is confirmed for 1 March. All employees must complete their profile migration by 21 February. Key features going live: leave management, expense linking, performance review workflow. Training sessions scheduled for 17–19 February — attendance mandatory for all staff.

Decisions Made

- Lumière Direction A selected with terracotta accent integration — to be presented to client 14 February.
- Dune Collective pitch approved — budget AED 18,000, due 5 March.

- Workday go-live 1 March — all profile migrations complete by 21 February.

Action Items

Action	Owner	Deadline
Integrate terracotta accent into Direction A and finalise client deck	Priya Nair / Yuki Tanaka	13 Feb 2026
Begin Dune Collective strategy research and brief internal team	Tariq Osman	18 Feb 2026
Send Workday training calendar to all staff	Ravi Subramaniam	13 Feb 2026
Complete Workday profile migration — all staff	All employees	21 Feb 2026

Meeting 3: March All-Hands

Date: Wednesday, 11 March 2026 | Time: 9:30–11:10 AM

Location: Studio A + Microsoft Teams

Attendees:

- Sophia Al-Rashed — CEO (Chair)
- Marcus Webb — Creative Director
- Layla Haddad — Head of Client Services
- Tariq Osman — Senior Brand Strategist
- Priya Nair — Senior Designer
- Jonas Berger — Copywriter
- Fatima Al-Qassem — Account Manager
- Ravi Subramaniam — Operations Manager

Agenda Item 1 — Dune Collective Pitch Debrief

Layla confirmed Eternal submitted the Dune Collective pitch on 4 March. The pitch was well received — the client noted our strategy depth as a differentiator. A shortlist decision is expected by 20 March. The team discussed two things to refine regardless of outcome: the pitch deck template needs updating (current version is 2023 and feels dated), and the pricing model for campaign strategy work needs a new tiered structure. Marcus to lead deck refresh; Sophia to develop new pricing framework.

Agenda Item 2 — Lumière Delivery and Handover

The Lumière Hotel Group brand identity was approved by the client on 28 February — Direction A with the terracotta accent was selected with minor copy revisions. Final brand guidelines document delivery is scheduled for 20 March. Marcus confirmed the guidelines are 85% complete. Jonas is finalising the tone of voice section. Layla noted the client has already asked about scope for the launch campaign — this will be treated as a new project and scoped accordingly. A follow-on proposal to be prepared by Fatima.

Agenda Item 3 — Hiring: Senior Account Manager

With the agency's client roster growing in the premium segment, Layla made the case for a Senior Account Manager hire. The role would manage 4–6 retained clients independently, freeing Layla for new business and relationship management at the director level. Sophia approved the hire; budget is within the Q2 people plan. Job description to be posted by 20 March; target start date end of April.

Agenda Item 4 — Q1 Financial Summary

Ravi shared headline numbers from the CFO: revenue for Q1 is tracking at 91% of target — the Al Baraka pause accounts for most of the shortfall. Gross margin is up 4 points year-on-year due to reduced freelance spend on retainer projects. If Dune Collective is won, Q2 is projected to land at or above target.

The board has asked for a revised H2 forecast to be ready by the April board meeting.

Decisions Made

- Senior Account Manager hire approved — post to go live 20 March.
- Pitch deck template refresh to begin immediately — owner: Marcus.
- New campaign pricing framework to be developed by Sophia for Q2 rollout.
- Follow-on Lumière launch campaign proposal to be scoped — owner: Fatima.

Action Items

Action	Owner	Deadline
Post Senior Account Manager job description	Layla Haddad / People & Culture	20 Mar 2026
Complete and deliver Lumière brand guidelines	Marcus Webb / Jonas Berger	20 Mar 2026
Draft Lumière follow-on campaign proposal	Fatima Al-Qassem	25 Mar 2026
Begin pitch deck template refresh	Marcus Webb	27 Mar 2026
Develop new campaign pricing tier structure	Sophia Al-Rashed	31 Mar 2026
Prepare H2 forecast for April board meeting	Ravi Subramaniam	3 Apr 2026